

Current Liabilities

Current liabilities are amounts due that are payable within the next twelve months. These also include provisions which are amounts set aside for an expense incurred for which the bill has not been received as yet or whose cost has not been fully estimated.

Trade Creditors

Trade creditors are those to whom the company owe monies for raw materials and other articles used in the manufacture of its products. Companies usually purchase these on credit, the credit period depending on the demand for the item, the standing of the company and market practice.

Accrued Expenses

Certain expenses such as interest on bank overdrafts, telephone costs, electricity and overtime are paid after they have been incurred. This is because they fluctuate and it is not possible to either prepay or accurately anticipate these expenses. However, the expense has been incurred. To recognize this, the expense incurred is estimated, based on past trends and known expenses incurred and accrued on the date of the Balance Sheet.

Provisions

Provisions are amounts set aside from profits for an estimated expense or loss. Certain provisions such as depreciation and provisions for bad debts are deducted from the concerned asset itself. There are others, such as claims that may be payable, for which provisions are made. Other provisions normally seen on balance sheets are those for dividends and taxation.

Sundry Creditors

Any other amounts due are usually clubbed under the all embracing title of sundry creditors. These include unclaimed dividends and dues payable to third parties.